

Super skull

Some fossils are almost perfectly preserved. After millions of years buried under rock, this *Tyrannosaurus* skull did not need much patching up in the fossil laboratory!



Building *Tyrannosaurus rex*

This skeleton of *Tyrannosaurus rex* has been on display in an American museum since 1915. Today, scientists think that a big mistake was made in the way the skeleton was put together. They now think the *Tyrannosaurus* held its tail up high above the ground.

A strong ribcage protected its heart, liver, stomach and lungs.

Massive leg bones supported the dinosaur's weight.

Strips of steel run underneath each bone, fitting snugly into the bone's shape.

The metal framework supporting the skeleton is called an armature.

A strong metal pillar holds up the metal strips, supporting the full weight of the skeleton.

Model making

This model of a *Maiasaura* nest was sculpted by a scientific artist.



1. The basic *Maiasaura* shapes are made with wood and wire.



2. The nest site is built around the models. The wire skeletons are covered with paper and clay.



3. The clay models are carefully painted a sandy color. In life, *Maiasaura* was probably well camouflaged.

The tail bones were an extension of the *Tyrannosaurus*'s spine.